covid 19 pandemic policy

Version: 1.0 | Effective: | Review:

title: "Covid 19 Pandemic Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Policy Title: Covid-19 / Pandemic Policy Effective Date: [Insert Date] Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually or as guidance changes] Version: 1.0 Applies to: All staff, residents, contractors, volunteers, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], the safety and wellbeing of residents, staff, and visitors are our highest priority. Covid-19 and other pandemics present significant risks to vulnerable people in care settings. We are committed to implementing strong infection prevention and control (IPC) measures to reduce transmission, protect residents' health, and ensure the continuity of safe, person-centred care. We aim to: • Follow all government, NHS, and UKHSA guidance on pandemic management • Minimise risks of infection while supporting residents' rights, dignity, and wellbeing • Provide clear communication with residents, families, and staff regarding measures in place • Continuously adapt and improve based on emerging evidence and guidance

2. Purpose The purpose of this policy is to: • Set out the care home's approach to preventing and managing Covid-19 and other pandemics • Define roles and responsibilities of staff in implementing control measures • Provide guidance on infection prevention, outbreak management, and business continuity • Ensure compliance with regulatory and statutory requirements

3. Scope This policy applies to: • All areas of the care home environment • All staff, residents, visitors, contractors, and healthcare professionals entering the home

4. Roles and Responsibilities Registered Manager: • Ensures compliance with latest guidance from the Department of Health & Social Care, CQC, and UKHSA • Oversees outbreak response and communication with authorities • Ensures adequate PPE, testing kits, and cleaning supplies are available • Supports staff wellbeing and continuity of service delivery Infection Control Lead: • Monitors infection prevention practices and conducts audits • Provides staff training and updates on emerging guidance • Acts as point of contact for outbreak management All Staff: • Follow IPC protocols, including PPE use, hand hygiene, and testing requirements • Report symptoms of Covid-19 or other infectious illnesses immediately • Support residents to follow safety measures in a compassionate, person-centred way Residents and Visitors: • Are expected to follow infection control measures (hand hygiene, PPE where required, testing where advised) • Cooperate with temporary restrictions or adjustments for safety reasons

5. Key Measures 5.1 Infection Prevention and Control • Enhanced cleaning and disinfection of high-touch areas and communal spaces • Strict hand hygiene protocols for staff, residents, and visitors • Use of PPE in line with guidance (e.g., masks, gloves, aprons) • Ventilation of

shared areas where possible 5.2 Testing and Screening • Staff and residents may be tested in accordance with current NHS/UKHSA guidance • Visitors may be asked to provide proof of a negative test in outbreak situations • Symptomatic staff, residents, or visitors must not enter communal areas until tested and cleared 5.3 Vaccination • Residents and staff will be supported to access recommended vaccinations (e.g., Covid-19 boosters, flu vaccines) • Vaccination records will be maintained securely in line with GDPR 5.4 Visitors • Visiting will remain supported but may be adapted during outbreaks (e.g., booking systems, designated visiting areas, PPE requirements) • End-of-life visits will always be prioritised with compassion and flexibility 5.5 Outbreak Management • Immediate isolation of symptomatic or confirmed positive residents • Notify UKHSA Health Protection Team and CQC of outbreaks • Enhanced cleaning, PPE, and restricted movement measures will be implemented • Business continuity arrangements will ensure safe staffing and service provision

6. Staff Health and Wellbeing • Staff must not attend work if unwell or displaying Covid-19/pandemic-related symptoms • Occupational health support and risk assessments will be provided for vulnerable staff • Wellbeing support, counselling, and flexible arrangements will be made available

7. Communication • Residents and families will be updated promptly about visiting arrangements and outbreak situations • Staff will receive clear and timely updates on guidance changes • Information will be communicated in accessible formats for residents

8. Training and Awareness • Staff will receive induction and refresher training on IPC, PPE, and outbreak management • Training will include updates on emerging threats and government guidance

9. Monitoring and Audit • Regular IPC audits will be conducted • Cleaning and PPE compliance will be monitored • Outbreak responses will be reviewed to identify lessons learned

10. References • Department of Health & Social Care (DHSC) Guidance • UK Health Security Agency (UKHSA) Infection Prevention and Control Guidance • Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards • Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014

11. Related Policies • Infection Prevention & Control Policy • Business Continuity & Emergency Planning Policy • Visitor Policy • Staff Health and Wellbeing Policy • Risk Assessment Policy

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